

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Zekiye Sen

Address: 21 Priory Avenue North Cheam SM3 8LU

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing in strong support of this planning application for the conversion of the former ambulance station into a Masjid and Community Centre.

This proposal would meet a genuine and growing need. Muslim residents in this borough currently lack sufficient local worship and community space, meaning families, the elderly, and young people must travel unnecessarily long distances. A facility of this kind would change that.

I would also like to address some of the concerns raised in objections. On traffic: the site previously operated as a 24-hour emergency ambulance station with large heavy vehicles responding at all hours. A community and worship facility will generate a fraction of that activity, concentrated at predictable times. This is an improvement, not a deterioration, for local residents and the school nearby.

On noise and amenity: mosques and Islamic centres across the UK are well-established community institutions known for their calm and orderly congregations. They are not sources of antisocial noise. The concerns raised do not reflect the reality of how these facilities operate in practice.

Converting a vacant building into an active, positive community hub - offering prayer, education, youth activities, and support services open to all - is exactly the kind of development our area needs. I urge the planning committee to approve this application.